The Test is poised. Batting seems difficult, but the tourists appear to be taking the initiative as Cheteshwar Pujara and Virat Kohli gather momentum and start to score freely.

'AB, do you want to bowl?'

I realise Graeme is speaking, but I am surely mishearing him.

'AB, we need to try something different in the last over before tea. Do you want to bowl?'

'Sure,' I reply, with all the confidence of someone who has sent down a grand total of 38 overs of dibbly-dobbly medium pace and occasional off-spin in my entire professional career.

The Test match pauses while I remove my wicketkeeping gloves and pads, hand them to Hashim, who is going to replace me for this one over, and try to appear calm as I pace out my two-step run-up.

First ball: short and wide, slapped to the cover sweeper for one by Cheteshwar. Second ball: Virat sympathetically and kindly leaves a wide half-volley and Hashim collects. Third ball: Virat pushes a single to the covers. Fourth ball: Cheteshwar drives off the back foot and runs two. Fifth ball: dragged down, it's called a wide outside off stump. Sixth ball: it turns and Cheteshwar defends with respect. Last ball: Cheteshwar plays the ball to mid-off, no run.

Having somehow survived this barrage of top-class bowling, the Indians reach tea at 109 for two and thrive into the evening and the next day. They are eventually bowled out for 421, leaving us an apparently impossible target of 458 runs to win. The travelling journalists are already beginning to prepare triumphant reports of what they are calling 'one of India's greatest Test wins'.

In fairness, our prospects don't look great with more than a day and a half left in the game and, even though Graeme and Alviro open our innings with a steady century partnership, we lose three quick wickets and Jacques gets a poor LBW decision, and we appear to be slip-sliding away at 197 for four.